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CUTTING WORKOUT PROGRAM

A SET FOR SET Workout Program for
Cutting Weight & Losing Fat.



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Whether you are looking to cut weight for summer, a fitness event, or simply to achieve your ideal body mass index (body fat percentage), we guarantee this cutting workout and diet plan will get you there.

This program has everything you need to know about cutting. We lay out exactly what you need to eat and a workout program for you to follow.

Our ultimate goal with this cutting (aka fat loss) plan is to help you lose fat while maintaining as much muscle mass as possible.



WHAT IS CUTTING?

In the world of fitness, especially bodybuilding and strength training, the term cutting refers to losing weight while retaining as much muscle mass as possible.

Really, the key point is at the end of the statement above.

For a cut to be truly successful, the trainee must be able to restrict muscle loss. If not, you are not really “cutting”, rather you are simply losing weight.

So, the goal of any good cutting workout & diet plan, ours included, is to take pounds off the scale while maintaining pure muscle mass.

That means the *pounds* must mainly be *FAT*.

To do that, we must eat at a slight deficit and continue weight training (and for most, up the cardio).

There's obviously more to cutting, but before we get into the *how* of cutting, let's go over some frequently asked questions about cutting, as we are sure you'll be wondering the same things.

If you were looking for a simple fat loss workout program, you got one even better!



CAN YOU CUT WITHOUT LOSING MUSCLE?

While the goal of a cutting phase is to lose fat while maintaining muscle, a little muscle loss may occur along the way.

However, as long as you cut using a reasonable deficit, keep your protein intake high, and continue lifting weights, muscle loss will be very negligible.

Most people make out the whole “losing muscle when cutting” to be a bigger deal than it really is.

In fact, it’s pretty hard to lose a significant amount of muscle as long as you aren’t on a starvation diet, doing super long cardio sessions (marathon long), and/or doing a strict cutting plan for way too long (all year round, which is obviously not sustainable).

All in all, you really don’t need to worry much about muscle loss when cutting.

If you follow a plan like ours, you will certainly maintain most of your muscle mass.

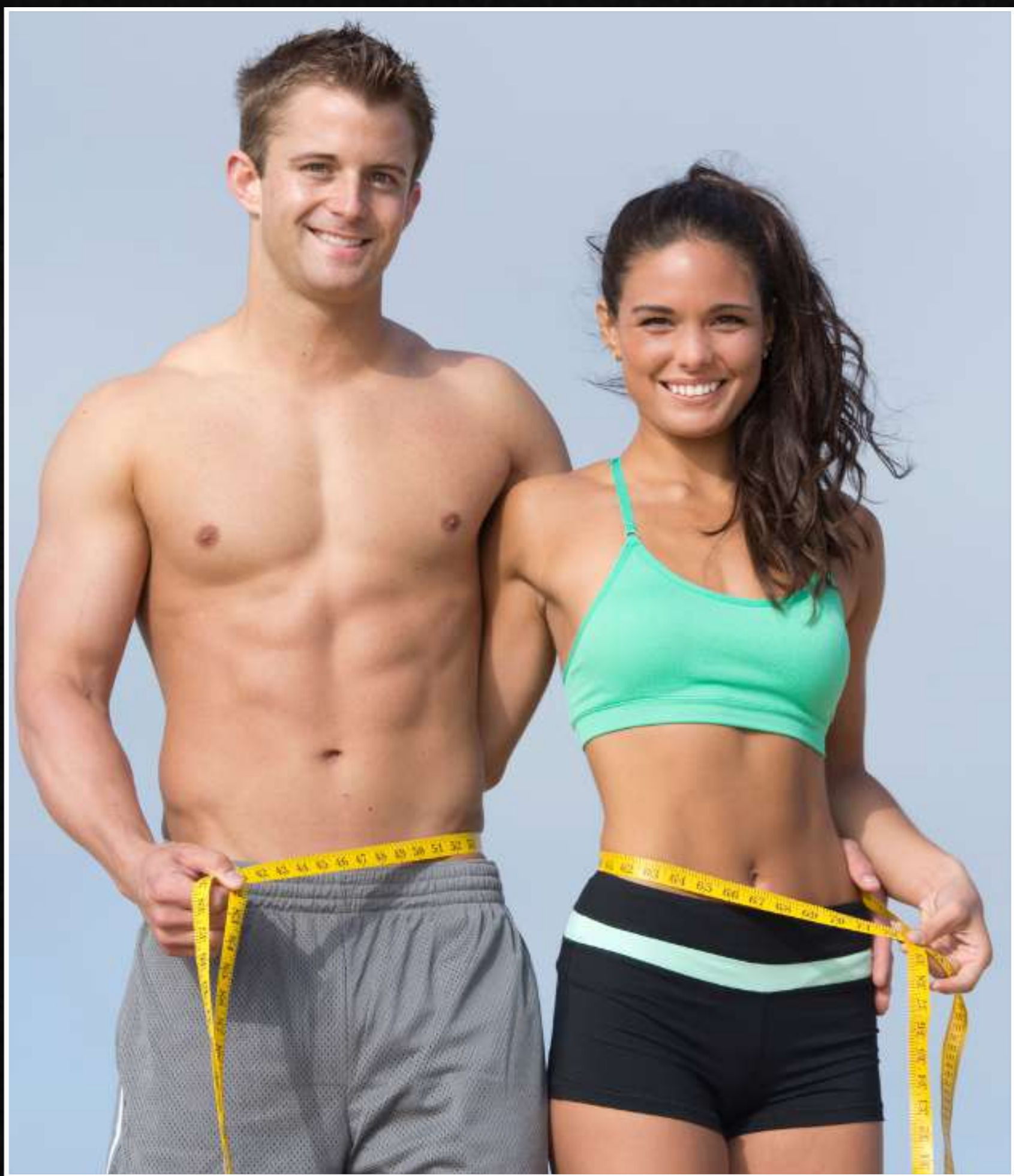
Also, it should be noted, the slower the fat loss, the less likely muscle will be loss.



A slow and proper cut should see little to no muscle loss.

Of course, don't expect to gain muscle (or strength) on a cut, as that simply goes against science (calories in vs calories out - you can't gain weight on a deficit).

We will get into the details of what your diet and workouts should be further below.



SHOULD YOU BULK OR CUT FIRST?

It depends on the individual.

As cutting is more than just losing weight, it's about losing fat while maintain muscle mass as best as possible, bulking is more than just gaining weight, it's about building muscle (while hopefully not getting too fat **cough cough** clean bulk FTW).

Now, back to the question...

You will see good results as long as you train hard and eat a healthy diet. The worst thing you can do is succumb to paralysis by analysis.

If you are a beginner who is considerably overweight, then the first thing you should do is obviously lose fat, so following a cutting plan is the way to go.

If you are skinny, then you obviously should bulk up.

Where people get a little confused is when they are in the middle...the infamous, SKINNY FAT. If you are skinny fat, you could go either way.



Some recommend putting on muscle first, others recommend cutting.

Is it possible to lose fat and gain muscle at the same time?

According to this study, where a group of young men were able to lose 7 pounds of fat while gaining 3 pounds of muscle within 4 weeks by following a strength training program and increasing protein intake while at a caloric deficit, IT IS.

This is especially true for beginners.

In terms of body composition, you will look a lot better with considerable muscle at a lower body fat percentage than without.

So, if you are seriously lacking muscle, then just focus on gaining muscle and don't worry about belly fat yet.

Plus, the more muscle you have, the more fat you will burn when resting and newbies will shed off that belly fat even on a clean bulk.

FOR EVERYONE ELSE...

If you are intermediate to advanced, then you probably already know what to do, but to answer the question...



A healthy body fat percentage for men is anywhere from 10-17%.

However, athletes may be a little lower, especially during their respective season.

And, as you get older, being on the higher side (even around 20% BF in your 50s) is fine.

So, if you are simply worried about your health, then do a cut if and when you are above ~17% body fat percentage.

If you simply want to look leaner, then do a cut until you reach your body fat percentage goal.

Most people do this in the lead up to summer, at which time shirts come off often.

For most men, being around 10-12% will look great, so you can plan a cut to this body fat percentage.



A healthy body fat percentage for women is around 21-31%.

Women athletes may be lower, i.e. around 14-20% and women who take fitness very seriously yet not competitively around 21-24%.

The same rules for men apply to women.



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Women athletes may be lower, i.e. around 14-20% and women who take fitness very seriously yet not competitively around 21-24%.

The same rules for men apply to women.

You should cut if you want to reach a certain body fat percentage for an event, summer or just for how you want to look OR if you are above the healthy range.

Generally speaking, most lifters do phases of bulking and cutting as bulking will enviably come with some fat increase.

So to maintain the body fat percentage they want, they will pack on some muscle then do a 8-12 week cut (some even shorter).

That said, if you are already happy with your body fat percentage, you can just do a very slow bulk (aka a clean bulk). That way you shouldn't have to worry much about the whole bulking then cutting then bulking then cutting thing.



HOW LONG SHOULD YOU CUT FOR?

A cutting diet typically lasts 8-16 weeks, with 12 weeks usually being the best as it allows for a slower cut that minimizes or completely restricts muscle loss.

Can you do a cutting diet all year round?

There would be no point to do a non-stop cut.

Once you reach your ideal body fat percentage, then you would want to maintain or build muscle.

You obviously can't keep losing weight forever. Moreover, a cutting workout plan is non sustainable.

You simply can't train hard and eat at a deficit for long periods of time.

This is why 8 to 12 or 16 weeks is recommended for cutting phases.

Most research shows that you can lose about 1 pound of fat per week, healthily, without noticeable muscle or performance loss.

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1 LB OF FAT = 3,500 CALORIES



WHEN TO START CUTTING?

This depends on the purpose of your cut.

Are you cutting for a sporting event (i.e. bodybuilding competition), season (i.e. summer) or special date (i.e. wedding)?

If so, give yourself 8-12 weeks for a cut. If you have an event July 1st, you should start your cut at the latest May 1st or the earliest March 1st.

Are you cutting just to reach your ideal body fat percentage?

If so, then start anytime you want.



KEY ASPECTS OF LOSING FAT

1. SET YOUR GOAL:

Before you start, know what you want to achieve.

Whether that's a specific body fat percentage or simply your abs showing very visibly, make it clear so you know what you are working towards.

2. TIMELINE:

Set a specific timeline to reach that goal. If you know how much weight you need to lose for an event or what body fat percentage you are working towards, then you can plan your diet accordingly.

So, set a start and end date. Remember, you can't cut forever.

Cutting is a lot more tiring and difficult than bulking for most, but it's easier if you do things slowly.

If you have the time, give yourself something like 12 weeks.

If you only have 4-8 weeks, then you can make it work, but you'll need to plan accordingly.

Our cutting program is set for 12 weeks, which is the best, but it can be adapted easily to any number of weeks from 4-16 weeks by adjusting the calorie deficit, which we teach you.

Most research shows that 1 pound of fat loss/weight per week is perfectly healthy and doable with minimal muscle and performance loss.

3. DIET:

You'll need to hone in on your diet during a cut. You need to be in a calorie deficit. There are two ways to do this: eat less and burn more calories. Also, pick healthy options found on our best [food for muscles](#) list.

We'll break down a diet plan for you below.

4. WORKOUT:

Working out is just as important for cutting as you want to minimize or completely restrict muscle loss during a cut. If you were just "losing weight" then you could do so based just on diet, but this program is about losing fat and keeping muscle.

We also have a clear cut workout plan for you.



12 WEEK CUTTING WORKOUT & DIET PLAN

We based this program on 12 weeks as this will allow you to have a slow cut that maximizes fat loss and minimizes muscle and performance loss. However, we'll show you how you can adjust the length of time by simply altering your calorie intake.

Either way, all of the same rules will apply no matter what length of time you choose for your cut, as will the workouts.

[DIET PLAN](#)

[WORKOUT PLAN](#)

Click or keep scrolling down



CUTTING DIET PLAN

When it comes to cutting, everything depends on your diet. Your results will be directly correlated to your diet. It doesn't matter how hard you workout, if your diet is poor, your results will be too.

This is why we are digging into the diet plan before the workout plan.

Calories
Macros
Meals Per Day
Best Foods
Daily Meal Example

Click to go to the section or scroll down



CALORIE INTAKE

The fundamental aspect of your diet comes down to calorie intake. As this is a cut, you will want to be on a calorie deficit.

Since this is a 12 Week Cutting Plan, we will break this down based on 12 weeks.

TDEE Calculator:

Before you start, you need to figure out your calorie maintenance level.

To do this, you can use a TDEE (total daily energy expenditure) calculator.

You just plug in your info and it is going to tell you your calorie maintenance level.



Recommended TDEE Calculator

As you lose weight, you will need to keep track of your maintenance level as it will change slightly.

Note: Here is a [calorie calculator](#) to count your calories. This will make keeping track a lot easier. There are also apps you can use.

Managing Your Calorie Deficit:

Rather than just dropping 300-500 calories below your maintenance level right away, the best way to cut is with a taper.

A taper will allow you to easily adjust to the lower calorie intake and not feel sluggish or let your workouts suffer.

Here is how it'll look week by week:

- Week 1: Maintenance level
- Week 2-4: 100-200 below maintenance
- Week 5-8: 200-300 below maintenance
- Week 9-10: 300-500 below maintenance
- Week 11: 200-300 below maintenance
- Week 12: 100-200 below maintenance

Another way to look at it is:

- Week 1: Maintenance
- Week 2-4: 90% maintenance
- Week 5-7: 85% maintenance
- Week 8-10: 80% maintenance
- Week 11: 85% maintenance
- Week 12: 90% maintenance



For those who only have 8 weeks, your taper can look like this:

- Week 1: Maintenance
- Week 2: 90% maintenance
- Week 3: 85% maintenance
- Week 4: 80%
- Week 5-6: 75%
- Week 7: 80%
- Week 8: 85-90%

You could even be more aggressive than this. For example, by week 2 be at a 500 calorie deficit and then maintain this until week 8.

Your workout plan will be the same for 4, 8, 12, or 16 weeks, so all you need to do is focus on your calories when it comes to the length of your cut.

After You Reach Your Target:

When you reach your fat loss goal, you should do a maintenance period that lasts around 2-4 weeks. Simply eat at your new maintenance level for a while and let your body adjust.

When you finish your maintenance period, you can begin to gradually increase your calories if you want to build muscle.



Considerations:

1. Adjustments depending on your target:

If you want to run a calorie deficit longer, we recommend staying in the 200-300 below maintenance level for the majority of your fat loss journey.

Conversely, if you reach your target sooner than planned, simply taper back up to your new maintenance level over a week or two.

After you reach your target, don't start eating whatever you want or you will just blow right back up and gain all that fat back.

Lastly, you should adjust your calorie intake if your daily activities increase.

2. Readjust based on new maintenance levels each week:

Since you will be losing weight along the way, your maintenance level will drop a little.

However, don't stress this too much. It's hard to be super exact with calorie expenditure and intake. Just do your best. It's all an experiment and as you move through your cutting phase, you will really start to understand your body more.



MACROS

Your macronutrients are what make up your calories (energy).

The 3 Macros:

- Protein
- Carbohydrates
- Fats

Your macros will look different on a cut than they do on a bulk. On a cut, you will be on a high protein diet, since sparing muscle mass is priority.

Complicated Method:

- Weight Training Days: 32% Protein, 20% Fat, 48% Carbs
- Cardio Days: 32% P, 30% F, 38% C
- Rest Day: 32% P, 40% F, 28% C

Simple Method:

If you don't want to worry about changing things up everyday, you can really just stick to either:

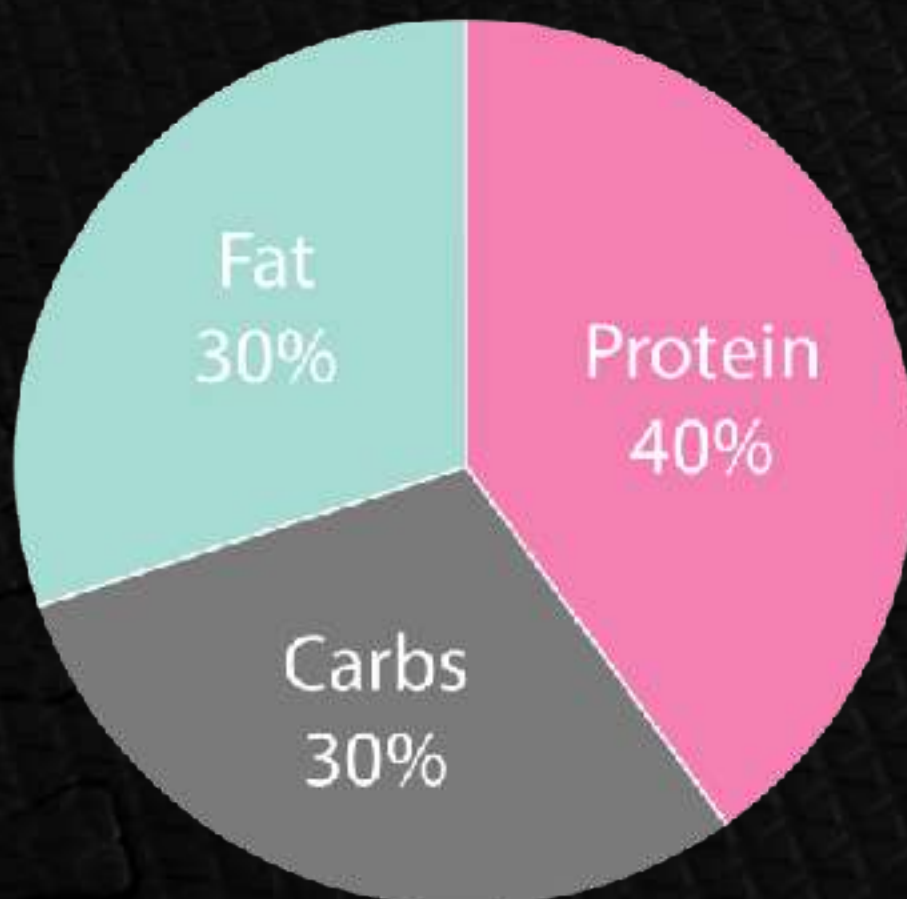
- 40% P, 30% F, 30% C
- 50% P, 40% F, 20% C



If you don't want to deal with too much calculations, the simplest way is to just eat carbs in moderation, up your fat intake a little (healthy fats), and increase your protein intake to 1g per pound of bodyweight. So, if you weigh 200lbs, you will want to eat 200 grams of protein each day.

You can always play around with your macros based on how you feel and progress. You may need to decrease carbs or increase fat. But one thing that should really remain consistent is your protein intake of 1g/lb of bodyweight.

For the first few weeks as you taper down your calories, you can be at .8-1g, but once you are in the thick of your cut, you will want to be at 1g+ per lb of bodyweight per day. More protein can't hurt as long as you are eating healthy and keeping your total calories where they should be.



MEALS PER DAY & WHEN TO EAT

When cutting, it's best to eat multiple smaller meals per day. If you are wondering about intermittent fasting when cutting, reports are conflicting and we don't recommend it for two reasons:

1. Your macros can get screwy.
2. Your workouts may not be as great if in a fasted state.

So, we recommend **4-6 meals per day**. i.e. breakfast, lunch, snack, dinner, before bed snacks. You could also just do small, even meals throughout the day, like you see when bodybuilders meal prep.

Note: Work your macros and total calorie intake into those meals.

Also, be sure to time one of your meals post workout in order to support muscle recovery and repair.

Lastly, you shouldn't ever get very full, but you should feel content after a meal. This will help keep your metabolism up and digestive system running great.



BEST FOODS

You will want to eat healthy, unprocessed foods when cutting, aka nutrient dense foods.

They will give you the best bang for your buck and help you to feel full because you can eat more of these foods while staying at your required calorie intake.

The following pages will cover:

- What you should eat
- What foods you should avoid
- What foods help with fat loss
- Sample breakfast meal
- Sample lunch meal
- Sample dinner meal
- Sample snacks



What should you eat when cutting?

- Meats (chicken, beef, salmon, pork, lamb)
- Protein powders (whey or plant based)
- Nuts and seeds
- Beans
- Avocados, olive oil, and olives
- Whole grains (brown rice and pasta, oats, whole grain bread, barley, and quinoa)
- Leafy greens and different vegetables
- Berries

Your diet can be rich, just be sure its not processed garbage and it works with your macros.

Also, try to avoid liquid calories, because they add up fast and they don't keep you full! Water is your best liquid friend on a cut. Milk is ok too in moderation.



What foods to avoid while cutting?

- Most sausages and bacon
- Sugary drinks
- Most fruit juices
- Fried foods
- Processed foods & cheeses
- White bread and rice
- Sweets and junk food
- Beer and any high calorie alcohol

Essentially, if you think it might be unhealthy, it likely is...

Alcohol:

If you want to drink alcohol (here and there), then stick to whiskey, vodka, tequila or gin - neat, on the rocks, or with soda water - and of course don't overdo it.

A couple is fine. But even these will add up in calories. Whiskey is about 70 calories per shot. Vodka 64 calories.

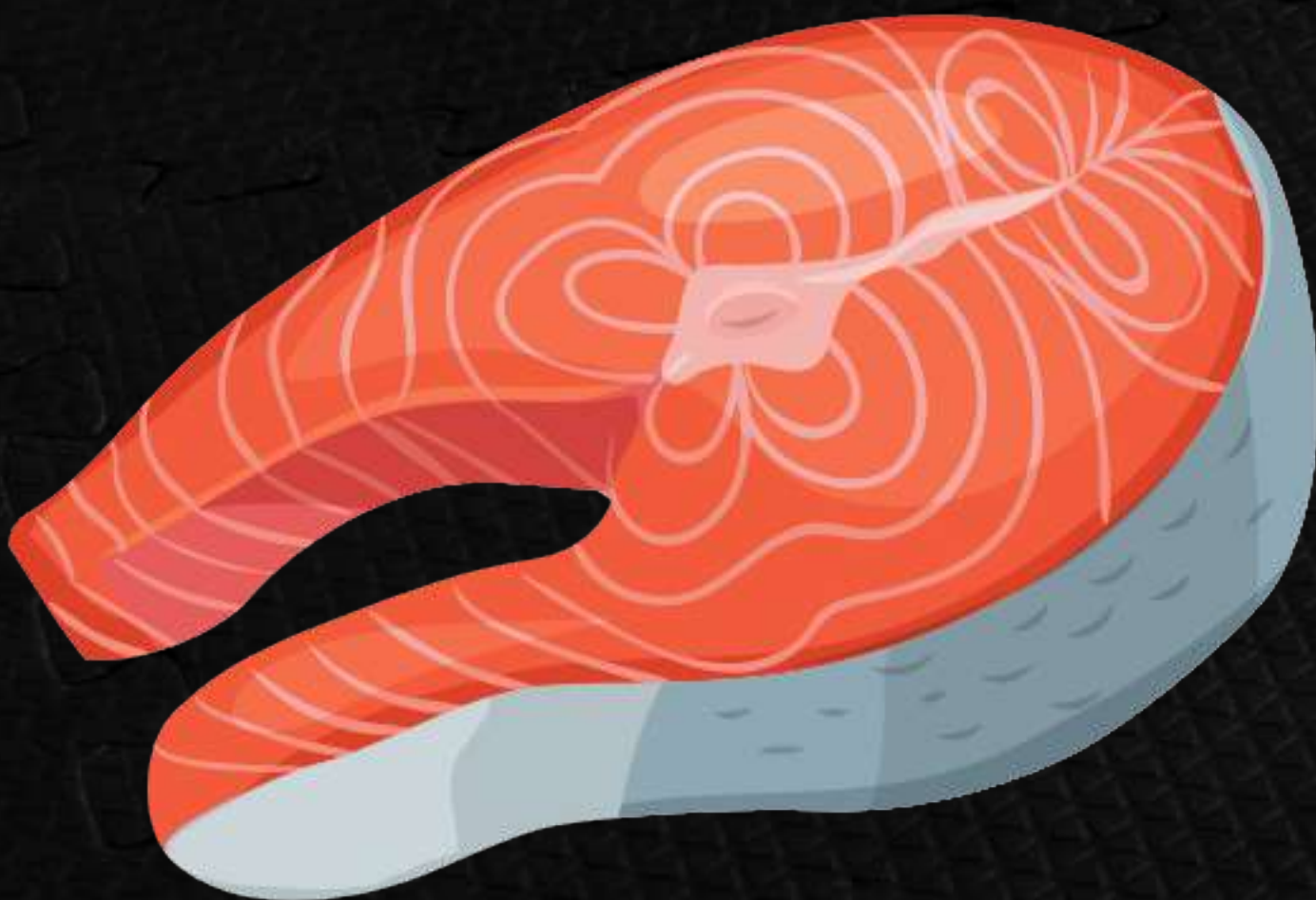
These are not carbs either, this kind of alcohol is essentially its own macro, so it's providing completely useless calories.



What foods help you lose fat?

Some foods are said to even help you lose fat! “Fat-burning” foods like:

- Fatty Fish (cod, salmon, anchovies)
- Eggs
- MCT Oil (use in moderation)
- Coffee (use in moderation)
- Green Tea
- Apple Cider Vinegar



Sample Breakfast Meal:

Most breakfasts are high in carbs, but what you want to do when cutting is eat a breakfast high in protein.

Sample breakfast when cutting:

- *Whole Eggs & Egg Whites*
- *1/2 Cup Oatmeal with Raspberries*
- *1 Cup Spinach*
- *Protein Shake*



Sample Lunch Meal:

As with breakfast, you'll want to make sure your lunch is high in protein.

Sample lunch when cutting:

- *200g Chicken*
- *Leafy Greens or Broccoli*
- *Whole Grain Bread with Avocado*



Sample Dinner Meal:

You don't need to be afraid of carbs at dinner. Carbs should be calculated over the course of a day. So, as long as you maintain that, it doesn't matter when you eat them really.

Sample dinner when cutting:

- *~200g Salmon Fillet*
- *Kale Salad with Goat Cheese and Seeds*
- *Rice with Olive Oil*



Sample Snacks:

The best snacks when cutting will be high in protein and fats. But sometimes you just need to put something in your stomach, so we will include that as well. Fiber is going to be your friend too during your cut.

Sample snacks when cutting:

- *Protein shake with natural almond or peanut butter*
- *Greek Yogurt with Berries and Half Scoop of Protein*
- *Pickles & Steak Slices*
- *Carrot Sticks*
- *Hummus and Celery*
- *Sunflower Seeds*
- *Boiled Eggs*
- *Almonds, Pecans or Walnuts*



DAILY MEALS EXAMPLE

If you are taking the 4-6 even-ish meals per day route, which we recommend, a day worth of eating will look like this:

- **Meal 1:** 6-10 egg whites, with ½ cup of oats.
- **Meal 2:** 150g chicken or fish, with ½ cup oats, 2 – 4 tspn natural peanut butter.
- **Meal 3:** 150oz chicken or fish, with 1/2-1 cup of brown rice, 2-4 tspn natural peanut butter.
- **Meal 4:** 2 scoop protein powder with 1–½ cup of oats (preworkout or coffee before gym)
- **Meal 5:** 200g chicken or fish, with 10oz sweet potato (post workout).
- **Meal 6:** 250oz chicken, with ½ cup of brown rice, 2-4 tspn natural peanut butter or almond butter.

There are so many ways to go about your diet on a cut, intermittent fasting included. All that really matters is your stay below your TDEE and you get enough protein. Also, that you are feeling good and can hit the weights relatively hard!



CUTTING WORKOUT PLAN

As minimizing muscle loss is a huge part of cutting, we need to get our workouts dialed in. We have two things to focus on when it comes to working out during a cut and that is *cardio* and *weightlifting*.

After we go over what you need to know about cardio and weightlifting, we will discuss your training schedule (you can choose 3, 4, 5 or 6 days per week) and then provide you with the workout program to follow.

Cardio
Weightlifting
Your Workout Plan
Training Days Per Week

Click to go to the section or scroll down



CARDIO

While some people don't even bother with cardio during a cut and they simply continue lifting weights and just eat less, we prefer to do cardio on a cut.

Why?

Because it heightens your metabolic rate and it burns more calories on the days you do cardio.

This means you can eat a little more, and who doesn't like to eat more if they can.

That said, you don't want to go overboard on cardio, so follow the instructions of our cutting workout plan below.

Two Types of Cardio:

There are two types of cardio that you can do, and you can do both depending on how you feel on any given day.

The two types of "cardio" you will do in our plan are:

1. Low Intensity Long Duration Cardio
2. HIIT (High Intensity Interval Training)



OPTION 1: LOW INTENSITY LONG DURATION CARDIO

Low intensity steady state cardio surely has its place in a cutting program, you just need to do it in moderation.

The reason some lifters avoid long duration cardio is because they worry about losing muscle. However, this is not something you need to think about as you won't be running for *that* long.

All it takes is 30-60 minute sessions of low intensity long duration cardio to get what you need in terms of fat loss, and with that, you *won't* sacrifice muscle mass.

It's once you get past the 60 minute point where muscle starts to be used for energy.

Many pro bodybuilders do low intensity long duration cardio (30-60 minutes) and for them preserving muscle is of utmost importance.

The key point of low intensity long duration cardio is to be LOW INTENSITY. By doing this, the main fuel will be your fat and your body will reserve the carbs for more intense exercise. So, as long as you don't go overboard on the intensity of your runs, you will be honed in on burning fat.



Low Intensity Long Duration Cardio Rules:

- **Duration:** Aim for 30 minutes at a minimum and 60 minutes at a maximum. Your body won't start using fat for energy until about the 15 minute mark.
- **Intensity:** Intensity is very important. Again, you want to go low intensity so that you use fat for energy. After your cardio session you should be comfortably tired, not damn near passed out on the floor in a pile of sweat. This means you should be running at around 60-75% of your max heart rate.
- **Variety:** You can use different mediums for cardio, such as running out side or on a treadmill, cycling, or other forms of cardio. Whatever you choose, just make sure you keep your heart rate to 60-75% max for 30-60 minutes. We recommend sticking to one form of cardio for one month, then switching to another for a month, then switching to another for the final month. That way you body doesn't get used to the cardio. You can also switch things up weekly or even daily.

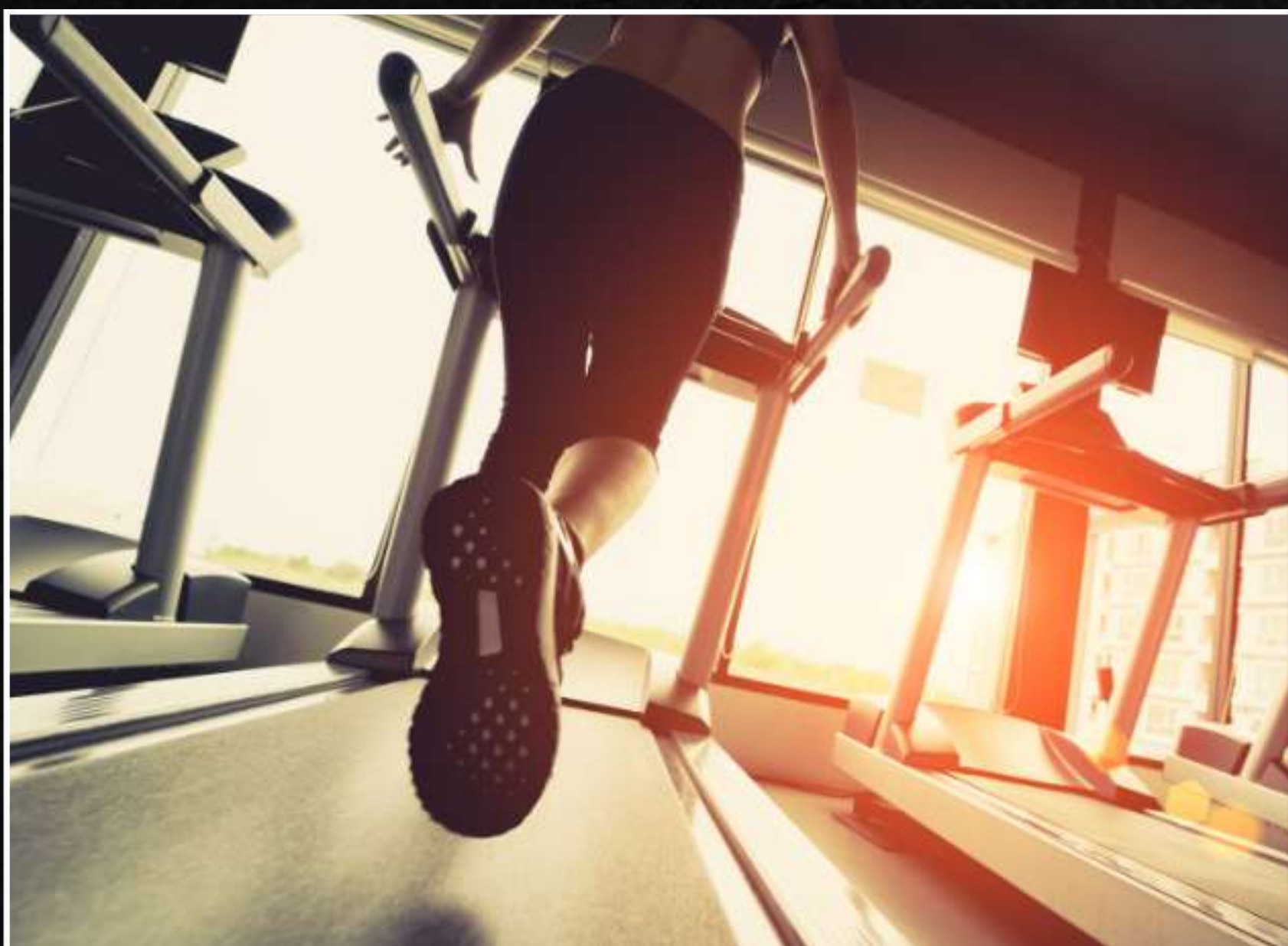


Low Intensity Cardio Pros:

- Best for people who are not already in great shape as it's easier.
- Main source of energy is fat not carbohydrates stores.
- Also works on endurance.

Low Intensity Cardio Cons:

- Can be boring.
- Doesn't work on fast twitch muscles (which are used in activities like sprinting and jumping).
- Only burns calories on the spot.



OPTION 2: HIIT

You must have heard of HIIT - High Intensity Interval Training.

HIIT involves a short burst of intense exercise (usually bodyweight movements or sprints) followed by a short period of rest or active rest, which is then repeated for a set time or number of rounds.

HIIT is great because you can burn as much calories as low intensity long duration cardio in a fraction of the time. With HIIT, all you need is around 15 minutes.

While the efficiency of HIIT is great, the real benefit comes after a HIIT workout due to the after burn effect.

After a HIIT workout, you will be burning calories at a higher rate than you normally would when resting. HIIT is great for keeping your metabolic rate strong.

The only downfall to HIIT is it is much more taxing than low intensity long duration cardio, so you can't do it all the time.

Just be aware of how you feel so that you don't end up overtraining yourself from HIIT.



How to do a HIIT Workout?

All you need to do for HIIT is have intervals of short bursts of 90-95% max heart rate with rest or active rest periods that keep you at around 60-75% max heart rate.

For example...

60 seconds jog (~65-70% max heart rate) x 15 second sprint (90-95% max heart rate), repeated without stopping for 10 minutes.

With HIIT, you can also choose different mediums.

However, running is usually the most straightforward and easiest to do correctly.

So, for our program, you will be doing running forms of HIIT. And we will keep your HIIT workouts to 10-20 minutes.



HIIT WORKOUTS

HIIT Workout #1:

Warm Up:	5 Minute Jog
Workout:	60 Seconds Run x 20 Seconds Sprint 10 Rounds (~13 mins total)
Cool Down:	Light jog for 2 minutes then walk for last 3 minutes

HIIT Workout #2:

Warm Up:	5 Minute Jog
Workout:	EMOM (Every Minute On the Minute) Treadmill HIIT: 15 seconds sprint (treadmill turned off - you power the belt - hands on treadmill handle) x 45 seconds rest x 16 rounds
Cool Down:	5 minutes walk and light stretch



HIIT Workout #3:

Warm Up:	5 Minute Jog
Workout:	10 sets of 100m sprints (walk back the 100m each set and immediately perform your next set when you reach the starting line) For the sprints, use a pyramid scheme for intensity. So your 10 sets will go like this (max speed not heart rate) 70%, 80%, 85%, 90%, 95%, 90%, 85%, 80%, 75%, 70%.
Cool Down:	5 Minute Walk



HIIT Pros:

- Short duration.
- Burns more calories, including after the workout is over.
- Can be adapted to sport specific training, so athletes can kill two birds with one stone.

HIIT Cons:

- Difficult for people who are out of shape to get an effective HIIT workout done.
- Carbs are the main source of energy, not fat.
- Wont' work endurance as much.



FREQUENCY & TIMING OF CARDIO

Our cutting plan will have you working out 6 days per week, with 3 days of cardio and 3 days weightlifting.

So, you will do cardio 3 times a week and it's up to you whether its low intensity long duration or HIIT.

You can choose one or the other or mix it up week by week or month by month.

For example, you may do one HIIT workout per week and 2 low intensity long duration workouts or vice versa. OR, maybe you do low intensity long duration cardio for 2 weeks, then HIIT for 2 weeks, then low intensity long duration cardio for 2 weeks, and so on and so forth. It's up to you, just get it done.

As for timing, we will place your cardio on non weight lifting days as it will allow you to have the most energy and is actually easier to manage than something like cardio in the morning and weight training in the evening 3 days per week.

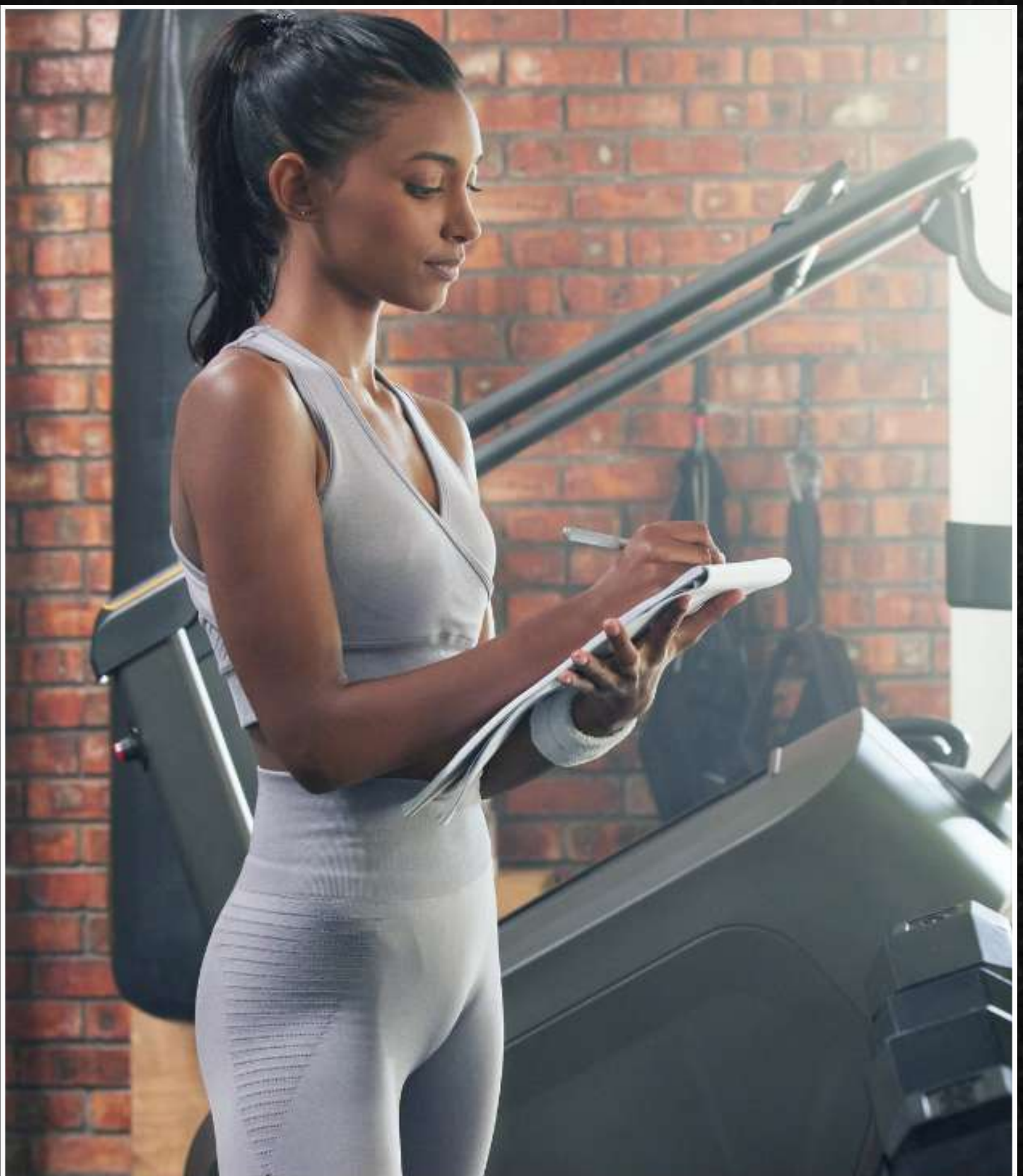
Moreover, you get more calorie burn spread throughout the week rather than just double on 3 days.



Note:

If you want to shorten your training schedule to 3-5 days per week, you can simply add the cardio session(s) to your weight training days, separated by at least several hours.

Since your weight training won't be as taxing as it would on bulk, you should also be able to manage this. We will explain all about scheduling later on in this program.



WEIGHTLIFTING

We don't mean to beat this point down too much but we will say it one last time, cutting is not just about losing fat, it's also about preserving muscle.

When it comes to a cutting phase, you shouldn't attempting a very heavy lifting schedule like you normally would.

You are restricting calories, so your energy will not be as good and thus neither will your strength.

Be that as it may, the goal is to continue training hard and keep your strength up as much as possible.

There are many weightlifting programs that you can do during a cut, but all should follow two key principles:

1. Focus On Large Muscles & Compound Exercises
2. Keep Your Heart Rate Up When Working Out

We will go over these in-depth on the following pages...



1. Focus On Large Muscles & Compound Exercises

The best workouts during a cut will focus on large muscle groups, and thus, compound exercises.

This is because compound exercises will give you the biggest bang for your buck in terms of maintaining strength, hypertrophy and even more importantly calorie burn (you are going to burn a lot more calories with a squat than a leg extension). Moreover, big compound lifts keep testosterone levels high.

So, your main focus will be your Legs, Back, Chest, and Core. But don't worry, your arms and shoulders will also get attention with our plan.

Here are the movements your workouts will/should revolve around:

- Squat
- Deadlift
- Lunge
- Bench Press
- Overhead Press
- Row
- Pull Up
- Core Work

Variations of these big lifts will be included (i.e. RDL, Incline Bench).



2. Keep Your Heart Rate Up When Working Out

Doing compound exercises burns more calories than isolation exercises, but that's only half the battle during cutting workouts.

You will also have to keep your rest time to a minimum.

Rather than taking 90-180+ seconds rest between sets like you may normally do during a bulking phase, you will need to keep your rest time between sets to 30-45 seconds on a cut.

That way you can maximize calorie burn. This kind of metabolic style of training will allow you to maximize hypertrophy with lighter weights as well.

So, your workouts will be volume-centric rather than load-centric.

You won't be lifting heavy, so long rest won't be needed.

But, you should still be challenging yourself with the weights.

You should be around 70-80% your 1RM for sets of 8-12.



Note:

A lot of cutting programs involve circuit training protocols, which have your rest time like 10-20 seconds between exercises and 60 seconds between rounds.

However, our cutting program is called HST (Hypertrophy Specific Training) so you will just stick to 30-45 seconds between sets.

All in all, no matter what program you choose when cutting, you should try to minimize rest to keep your heart rate up at a fat burning level for the duration of the workout so its kind of like a cardio/hypertrophy session.



HST WORKOUT CUTTING PROGRAM

For this cutting program, you will be doing Hypertrophy Specific Training (HST Workouts).

HST workouts are perfect for cutting. They are full body workouts that mainly focus on compound exercises.

The total weekly volume is spread out nicely throughout the week too, so it's manageable to get the volume needed each week to maintain muscle mass while on a calorie deficit.

You should have no issue with overtraining with our HST program.

Key Points of our HST Cutting Workout Plan:

- 3 full body workouts per week.
- Mainly compound exercises.
- 2 Exercises for each major muscle group per workout but only 3-4 sets in total spread between the 2 exercises.
- 23 sets per workout.
- 30-45 seconds rest between sets (only more if really needed).
- Reps of 8-12.
- Workout should take no longer than 60 minutes, but aim for 45 minutes.
- You can turn exercises into supersets at your own discretion.

On the following pages, we are going to take a close look at how the workouts are broken down.



Exercises & Sets:

Each workout will include:

- Legs: 2 exercises for a total of 4 sets
- Back: 2 exercises for a total of 4 sets
- Chest: 2 exercises for a total of 3 sets
- Shoulder: 2 exercises for a total of 3 sets
- Arms: 2 exercises (1 biceps, 1 triceps) for a total of 4 sets
- Calves: 1 exercise for a total of 1 set
- Core: 3 exercises (1 for upper abs, 1 for lower abs, 1 for obliques) for a total of 3 sets

Variety:

While this program is only 3 months, and you should be fine doing the same exercises for the duration of this cutting program, you can change up the exercises each month or even just the order of the exercises.

This is up to you and how you feel. If things are getting too easy, do this or simply decrease rest time a little each week.

Now, let us give you your 3 HST workouts, which you will do each week.



Reps:

You will be working in the 8-12 repetition range. It's ok if you go a little over or under this on a certain set if you end up choosing a weight load that is too light or too heavy.

Rest:

You have 23 sets in the workout, which is quite a bit. But, remember, you only have three workouts per week so the total weekly volume for each muscle group is ideal. You want to keep this structure.

However, you don't want your workouts to go too long, and you want to maximize calorie burn to get some cardio, fat burning effect as you lift. So, do your best to keep rest time to 25-45 seconds (maximum 60 seconds).

As you progress through the plan, you will likely be able to decrease rest time (rather than progressing by increasing load). This will help you to avoid plateau and keep your muscles overloaded appropriately for a cut.

If you notice your workouts are going a little long, implement supersets. You can superset the less taxing exercises like arms and calves.



YOUR CUTTING WORKOUT PROGRAM



WORKOUT A:

Back Squats	2 sets	8-12 reps
Stiff-Leg Deadlift	2 sets	8-12 reps
Chin Ups	2 sets	8-12 reps
Bent Over Barbell Row	2 sets	8-12 reps
Incline Dumbbell Bench Press	2 sets	8-12 reps
Parallel Dips	1 set	8-12 reps
DB Overhead Shoulder Press	2 sets	8-12 reps
Lateral Raise	1 set	8-12 reps
Dumbbell Curl	2 sets	8-12 reps
Triceps Kickback	2 sets	8-12 reps
Standing Calf Raise	2 sets	8-12 reps
Hanging Leg Raise	2 sets	8-12 reps
Side Plank with Hip Dip	1 set	8-12 reps



WORKOUT B:

<u>Barbell Bench Press</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Flat DB Chest Fly</u>	1 set	8-12 reps
<u>Deadlift</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>DB Lunges</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps each leg
<u>Barbell Overhead Press</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Farmer's Walk</u>	1 set	15-30 meters
<u>Pull Ups</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Barbell Shrugs</u>	1 set	8-12 reps
<u>Skull Crusher</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Hammer Curl</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Seated Calf Raises</u>	1 set	8-12 reps
<u>V-Ups</u>	2 sets	8-12 reps
<u>Side Bends</u>	1 set each side	8-12 reps



WORKOUT C:

Chin Ups	2 sets	8-12 reps
T-Bar Row	2 sets	8-12 reps
Incline Barbell Bench Press	2 sets	8-12 reps
Weighted Push Up	1 set	8-12 reps
Back Squats	2 sets	8-12 reps
Hip Thrust	2 sets	8-12 reps
Arnold Press	2 sets	8-12 reps
Upright Row	1 set	8-12 reps
Barbell Curl	2 sets	8-12 reps
Close Grip Bench Press	2 sets	8-12 reps
Standing Calf Raise	1 set	8-12 reps
Lying Leg Raise	1 set	8-12 reps
Stability Ball Crunches	1 set	8-12 reps
Alternating Heel Touches	1 set	8-12 reps



3, 4, 5, OR 6 DAYS PER WEEK

With this cutting program, you have several options for your workout schedule.

While you have a lot to do each week in terms of cardio and weightlifting, it can be split into 3, 4, 5, or 6 days per week.

That said, you'll still be doing the same amount of work each week regardless of which schedule you choose.

Let's look at how you can schedule everything out based on 3, 4, 5 or 6 days per week.

3 Days
4 Days
5 Days
6 Days

Click to go to the section or scroll down



3 Days Per Week:

- **Day 1:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout A (afternoon or evening)
- **Day 2:** Rest
- **Day 3:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout B (afternoon or evening)
- **Day 4:** Rest
- **Day 5:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout C (afternoon or evening)
- **Day 6-7:** Rest

Note: Do at least one HIIT session each week.

4 Days Per Week:

- **Day 1:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout A (afternoon or evening)
- **Day 2:** Rest
- **Day 3:** Workout B
- **Day 4:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 5:** Rest
- **Day 6:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout C (afternoon or evening)
- **Day 7:** Rest

Note: Do at least one HIIT session each week.

5 Days Per Week:

- **Day 1:** Workout A
- **Day 2:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 3:** Rest Day
- **Day 4:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT (morning) Workout B (afternoon/evening)
- **Day 5:** Workout C
- **Day 6:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 7:** Rest

Note: Do at least one HIIT session each week. Also, if you prefer to have the weekends completely off, you can do that, but the above is more ideal. It's better to have a rest day mid-week.

6 Days Per Week:

- **Day 1:** Workout A
- **Day 2:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 3:** Workout B
- **Day 4:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 5:** Workout C
- **Day 6:** Low Intensity Cardio or HIIT
- **Day 7:** Rest

Note: Do at least one HIIT session each week.

FINAL NOTES FOR SCHEDULING:

Just try to get your 3 weight training sessions and 3 cardio sessions done each week!

Worst case, if you need to skip a day, it won't kill you as you are doing full body routines so it's not like you'd have skipped a major muscle group.

Continue this for 12 weeks! And remember to follow the diet plan throughout the weeks.

Note: If you don't have 12 weeks, all the same rules apply, you'll just have to be more aggressive on your calorie deficit taper. Conversely, if you give yourself more time, you can have a smaller calorie deficit, which may be easier for some people to manage. It's really that simple.



TIPS FOR CUTTING FAT:

- Remember, it's all about calories. Know your Total Daily Energy Expenditure (TDEE) and keep your calorie intake below that. Find a good TDEE calculator when starting out and a food counter calculator or app.
- Watch your insulin levels. You know you need to avoid sugary foods, but remember, a lot of carbs spike blood glucose (sugar) levels, which turns into fat. Eat good sources of carbs to keep insulin leveled, such as oatmeal, brown rice, whole wheat bread, veggies, fruits, potatoes and sweet potatoes.
- Don't completely cut out carbs. A low carb diet is typically not the best for sustainable cutting or fat diet. You want a good ratio of macros. Try 40% - 30% - 30%, 40% - 40% - 20% or 50%-30%-20%, which is protein, carbs, and fats, respectively.
- Eat 5-6 meals per day. Don't try to get all your calories in one or two meals with intermittent fasting. It's best to have a constant flow of nutrients throughout the day. This will help with workouts and recovery and overall absorption of the the nutrients needed each day.
- Keep rest time low during workouts and do big compound movements.
- If you feel you are overtraining, take a **deload week** where you reduce the number of exercises or sets or the load for each exercise.
- Get plenty of sleep and HYDRATE, HYDRATE, HYDRATE.



Have Questions?

Our team is *#alwaysready* to answer any of your questions or concerns.

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HYPERTROPHY PROGRAM



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STRENGTH PROGRAM



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